

Code of Conduct & Ethics Policy

Behavioural Standards, Conflict of Interest and Patient Privacy

MediAssist Health Network

Office of Compliance & Human Resources

Document ref: COMP-COC-003 · Version 5.2

Applies to: All staff and contractors

1. Professional Conduct

Every MediAssist employee is expected to act with professionalism at all times. This includes punctuality, respectful communication, and respect for the clinical and administrative hierarchy.

Zero tolerance

MediAssist maintains **zero tolerance** for verbal or physical abuse directed at patients, visitors or colleagues. Substantiated abuse is treated as gross misconduct.

2. Patient Confidentiality

- Patient records, diagnoses and treatment details must **never** be disclosed outside authorised clinical and billing channels.
- Staff are bound by HIPAA-equivalent obligations under the Indian IT Act and applicable data-protection rules.
- **Photographing patients**, their records or their charts on personal devices is strictly prohibited.

3. Conflict of Interest

- Staff must not refer patients to external facilities, laboratories or pharmacies in which they hold a financial interest.
- Doctors must **disclose any relationship with pharmaceutical companies** (speaking fees, sponsorships, advisory roles) to the Office of Compliance annually.

4. Social Media Policy

- No posting of patient images, case details or identifiable information on any platform.
- No disparagement of MediAssist, colleagues, or competitor hospitals online.
- Personal opinions must not be presented as the official position of MediAssist.

5. Gifts & Gratuities

Gifts from patients or vendors are governed by value thresholds:

- Gifts valued **up to ₹500** are permitted; use professional judgement.
- Gifts valued **above ₹500** must be declared to administration.
- Gifts valued **above ₹2,000** must be refused, or deposited with administration.

6. Substance Abuse

- Zero tolerance for reporting to duty under the influence of alcohol or drugs.
- Clinical staff involved in an adverse patient event may be required to undergo mandatory testing as part of the investigation.

7. Anti-Harassment Policy (POSH)

- MediAssist has a constituted **POSH (Prevention of Sexual Harassment) Committee** at each campus, chaired by a senior woman officer with an external member.
- Complaints may be filed in writing or by email to posh@mediassist.in.
- Investigations are completed within a **15-day** internal timeline (statutory limit 90 days); penalties range up to termination.

8. Data & Systems

- No installation of unauthorised software on hospital devices.
- No sharing of login credentials under any circumstances.
- Suspected data breaches must be reported to IT Security **within 2 hours** of discovery.

9. Disciplinary Process

Disciplinary action follows a graduated process, proportionate to the conduct, escalating through four stages:

- 1** Verbal warning (documented).
- 2** Written warning.
- 3** Final written warning.
- 4** Termination.

Gross misconduct

Gross misconduct — including patient harm, data theft, billing fraud, or assault — may result in **immediate termination** without progressing through the stages above, subject to due process.

10. Anti-Bribery & Anti-Corruption

- No employee may offer, solicit or accept any bribe, kickback or improper inducement in connection with referrals, procurement, billing or recruitment.
- Facilitation payments to expedite routine approvals are prohibited.
- Commissions for patient referrals ("cut practice") are strictly forbidden and may attract legal action in addition to termination.

11. Vendor & Procurement Conduct

- All vendor selection must follow the documented procurement process with at least three quotations for purchases above ₹50,000.
- Staff with a personal or family interest in a vendor must recuse themselves and declare the interest to the Office of Compliance.

12. Whistleblower Protection

MediAssist encourages staff to report genuine concerns about unethical or illegal conduct without fear of retaliation.

- Concerns may be raised confidentially to **ethics@mediassist.in** or through the anonymous ethics hotline.
- Good-faith reporters are protected; retaliation against a whistleblower is itself a disciplinary offence.
- Knowingly false or malicious reports, however, are treated as misconduct.

13. Acknowledgement

Declaration

Every employee signs an annual declaration confirming they have read, understood and will abide by this Code of Conduct. The signed declaration is retained in your personnel file on the HR Portal.

Document ref: COMP-COC-003 · Version 5.2 · Owner: Office of Compliance & HR